

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Comprehensive Technical Project Documentation Report

Date	23/09/2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-3089
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
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Maximum Marks	Major Project

1. Executive Summary & Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

2. User Story & Project Objectives

"As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention."

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

3. Milestone-by-Milestone Implementation

Milestone 1: Flow Creation (Flow Designer)

- Step 1: Opened ServiceNow → Navigated to All → Process Automation → Flow Designer.
- Step 2: Clicked on 'New' → Selected 'Flow' → Specified Flow Name as 'Standard laptop task'.
- Step 3: Configured Application Scope as 'Global' and Run User as 'System user' → Submitted.

- Step 4: Clicked 'Add a trigger' → Selected 'Service Catalog' trigger → Clicked 'Done'.
- Step 5: Under Actions, added action 'Create Catalog Task'.
- Step 6: Dragged and dropped the 'Requested Item Record' data pill into the Request Item field.
- Step 7: Populated Short Description: 'Laptop need to Configured', Description: 'Laptop need to Configured'.
- Step 8: Selected Assignment Group field value as 'Hardware' and Approval as 'Approved'.

- Step 9: Saved and Activated the flow.




Flow VPN Flow Email sending for P1 Flow Standard laptop task +

Standard laptop task Inactive View:

TRIGGER

✕ Abort trigger creation

Trigger Select a Trigger

RECORD

Created

Updated

Created or Updated

DATE

Daily

Created

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

+ Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

+ Add an Error Handler

TRIGGER

Service Catalog

Trigger Service Catalog

Advanced Options

Delete Cancel Done

- Now under Actions.
- Click on Add an action.
- Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
- Mention these in that action
- Action as Create Catalog Task
- Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
- Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
- Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
- Click on add field value
- Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
- Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
- Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
- Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
- Click on save the Flow.
- And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

Milestone 2: Flow Assignment to Catalog Item

- Step 1: Navigated to All → Maintain Items in ServiceNow.
- Step 2: Searched for and selected the 'Standard Laptop' catalog record.

- Step 3: Navigated to the 'Process Engine' section.
- Step 4: Removed existing legacy automations and assigned the Flow 'Standard Laptop Task'.
- Step 5: Saved the record to finalize the association.



Are you sure you want to activate the flow?

Your flow will start running when the trigger conditions are met.

☐ Don't show me this again

Cancel

Activate

Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name " Standard Laptop Task".
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Milestone 3: Service Catalog Ordering & Approval Verification

- Step 1: Navigated to All → Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop.
- Step 2: Clicked 'Order Now' to submit a live request.
- Step 3: Opened the generated Request Number record → Navigated to 'Approvers' section.
- Step 4: Right-clicked the approval record and clicked 'Approve'.
- Step 5: Opened the Requested Item (RITM) record → Scrolled to 'Catalog Tasks' related list.

- Step 6: Verified: New task created with Short Description 'Laptop need to Configured' and Assignment Group 'Hardware'.



12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section
13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

A screenshot of the ServiceNow Catalog Task form for task SCTASK0010001. The form is titled "Catalog Task SCTASK0010001" and includes a header with navigation buttons: Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The form fields are organized into two columns. The left column contains: Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to (empty), Configuration item (empty), Active (checked), Short description (Laptop needs to Configured), Description (Laptop needs to Configured), and Worknotes (Worknotes). The right column contains: Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator). At the bottom right, there is a "Post" button. The bottom of the form shows "Activities: 1" and a dropdown arrow.

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

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